

Missing Child Chronology & Return Interview Log

TUSLA/AGS JOINT PROTOCOL · HIQA STANDARD 3 · S.I. 674/2017

▲ 15-MINUTE RULE: Under the Tusla/AGS Joint Working Protocol, An Garda Síochána must be notified within **15 minutes** of the child being identified as missing. The child's social worker and parent/guardian must also be notified. Activate the child's individual Absence Management Plan immediately.

1 MISSING INCIDENT RECORD

Incident Ref #	Child's Name / Ref	DOB
Date	Day of Week	Absence Management Plan on file? ☐ Yes ☐ No

2 REAL-TIME CHRONOLOGICAL LOG

Record every action taken, in real time, from the moment the child is identified as missing until return/resolution.

Time	Action / Event	By Whom	Outcome
	Child identified as absent / missing		
	Centre searched (all rooms, garden, outbuildings)		☐ Not found
	Known locations / associates checked / contacted		
	AGS notified (15-min rule)		Ref: _____
	Social worker notified		
	Parent / guardian notified		
	PIC / Manager notified		
	Director / Registered Provider notified		
	Tusla out-of-hours (if applicable)		

CHILD RETURNED / LOCATED

Time: _____

Total duration absent	Where found / how returned
Condition on return ☐ Unharmd ☐ Intoxicated ☐ Injured ☐ Distressed ☐ Other:	Medical attention? ☐ No ☐ Yes

3 RETURN INTERVIEW (WITHIN 24 HOURS)

Must be conducted by a staff member the child trusts. Record the child's own words. Do not force participation — if the child declines, record this and offer again later.

Interview Date / Time	Conducted By
Child willing to participate?	☐ Yes ☐ No — declined (offer again within 48 hours)

Question	Child's Response (in their own words)
Where did you go?	
Why did you leave?	
Who were you with?	
Were you safe while you were away?	
Did anything happen that worried you or made you feel unsafe?	
Did anyone hurt you or make you do anything you didn't want to?	
Did you use any substances?	
Is there anything that would help you stay in the centre?	
Safeguarding concern arising from return interview?	☐ No ☐ Yes — DLP notified & recorded separately
CSE / exploitation concern?	☐ No ☐ Yes — referred to SW / AGS
Substance misuse concern?	☐ No ☐ Yes — risk assessment updated

Interviewer Signature: _____ Date: _____

PIC Reviewed: _____ Date: _____

NIMS/SEN Submitted: ☐ Yes — Ref: _____ ☐ N/A

Missing Child — Master Tracker & Trend Analysis

SECTION 2 — ABSENCE MANAGEMENT · REPEATED ABSENCE TRENDS

4 ABSENCE MANAGEMENT PLAN REVIEW

Child has individual Absence Management Plan?	☐ Yes ☐ No — must be created
Plan reviewed after this incident?	☐ Yes ☐ N/A
Changes to plan agreed?	☐ No changes ☐ Yes — detail:
Social worker consulted?	☐ Yes ☐ No

Changes made to Absence Management Plan:

5 PIC INCIDENT REVIEW & LEARNING

Was the 15-minute AGS notification met?	☐ Yes ☐ No — reason:
Was the Joint Protocol followed correctly?	☐ Yes ☐ No — action:
Preventive actions identified?	
Triggers / patterns identified?	
Discussed at governance meeting?	☐ Yes — date: _____

PIC Signature: _____ Date: _____

6 MASTER ABSENCE TRACKER (PER CHILD)

Running record of all absences for this child. Filed at the front of the Absence Management section in the child's file.

#	Date	Day	Time Out	Time Back	Duration	AGS?	Where Found	Return Interview?	SEN?
1						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
2						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
3						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
4						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
5						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
6						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
7						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N
8						☐ Y		☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N

7 REPEATED ABSENCE TREND ANALYSIS

Completed when a child has 3+ absences in any rolling 3-month period, or at any governance meeting where absconding is on the agenda.

Analysis Period	Child	Total Absences This Period
Pattern / Trigger		
Specific days / times?		
Before / after family contact?		
Before / after school?		
Linked to specific peers / associates?		
Linked to specific staff / shift patterns?		
Substance use linked?		
Exploitation / CSE indicators?		
Emotional state / triggers identified?		

Trend direction: ☐ Increasing ☐ Decreasing ☐ Stable ☐ New pattern emerging

Multi-agency response required? ☐ No ☐ Yes — strategy meeting requested with SW / AGS

Actions from trend analysis:

Analysis By: _____ Date: _____
PIC Sign-Off: _____ Date: _____
Shared with Social Worker: ☐ Yes — Date: _____
Legislative Basis: Tusla/AGS Joint Working Protocol for Children Missing from Care · HIQA Standards 2018 (Standard 3) · S.I. 674/2017 · Children First Act 2015
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